

Assignment 1: Dirty Hands and Public vs Private Morality

Please reference the instructions in the Assignment 1 description on LEARN as well as the rubric while completing this assignment.

Complete Part 1: Simulation in LEARN before completing Part 2.

Part 2: Reflecting on the simulation (400 to 600 words)

Reflecting on content from Units 01 and 02 and your experience in the simulation, respond to **one (1) of the two (2)** options below using the DEAL model of reflection. Highlight or bold your selected option.

1. Discuss and reflect on how Selena faced a choice that involved dirty hands.
2. **Discuss and reflect on the struggle Selena faced when it came to choosing between her public and private morality.**

When writing your reflective response answer some of the following questions to help guide your thinking:

1. **Describe**, in your own words, a specific scenario from the simulation where Selena faced a choice that aligns with the concept of dirty hands or public vs private morality. What options were available in this choice? What was the outcome of your decision?

In the simulation, Selena faced a dilemma when she discovered that the consent form signed by Maximus—who had agreed to participate in a human stress-reduction experiment—did not fully disclose the potential risks and negative consequences. This raised ethical concerns about fairness and informed consent. Her options were to proceed with the study as planned, withdraw entirely, or raise her concerns with Giselle. I chose to have Selena approach Giselle. The outcome was that Giselle was disappointed, which could jeopardize future collaboration opportunities. Additionally, withdrawing at the final stage meant that Selena's prior efforts were not recognized, and she missed the chance to contribute to a project with potential large-scale benefits that could support her future career goals.

2. **Examine** Selena's choice from the perspective of the course content, which should be clearly referenced. Did your choice have a successful outcome? Would you change anything about your decision? How did this choice impact your understanding of the concepts of discussed in Unit 01 and Unit 02?

I believe the outcome was successful, and I would not change my decision. Selena's choice reflects the concept of private morality and aligns with the deontological ethics discussed in Unit 02. Although continuing the study could have benefited the public or advanced her career, doing so without fully informed consent would have compromised ethical standards. By choosing to speak up despite the personal cost, Selena upheld her duty to fairness and respect for persons. This scenario deepened my understanding that real-world ethical decisions often involve difficult trade-offs, and reaffirmed the importance of strong moral principles in responsible leadership.

3. **Articulate your learning** by summarizing what you learned from this experience. For example, what have you learned about your personal morality? Additionally, what factors might you consider when confronted with an ethical decision involving the concepts discussed in Unit 01 and Unit 02? What can you do to ensure you feel more prepared to make such a decision?

This experience helped me reflect on my own moral instincts and how they influence my decision-making in complex situations. When faced with ethical dilemmas, I've learned to ask myself: How would I feel if I were in the other person's position? In Selena's case, I imagined myself in Maximus's shoes—unaware of the full risks—and realized I would feel misled. That discomfort guided my decision to act with integrity, even at a professional cost.

I also recognized that my personal morality tends to prioritize fairness and empathy, but these values must be balanced with professional responsibilities. In future scenarios, I would consider not only the potential outcomes but also whether my actions align with core values such as transparency, respect, and accountability.

To feel more prepared, I plan to strengthen my familiarity with ethical frameworks like deontology and utilitarianism, which help evaluate both intent and impact. Practicing with real-world case studies, such as this simulation, allows me to build confidence in applying these frameworks thoughtfully. Ultimately, this experience has shown me the value of reflection, dialogue, and continuous learning in becoming a more ethically aware professional.

Part 3: Reflecting on a personal experience or situation (400 to 600 words)

Reflecting on content from Units 01 and 02 and your personal experience, respond to **one (1) of the four (4)** options below using the DEAL model of reflection. Highlight or bold your selected option.

1. Reflect on a situation where you (or someone you know) had to make a decision that involved dirty hands.

2. **Discuss a situation where it would be unwise to allow your private morality to influence the decisions you make at work.**
3. Discuss a situation where you believe it would be right to enforce your personal morals in the workplace over the expectations of your employer.
4. Reflect on a time when you or someone you know had to make a decision in the workplace where the difference between their public and private morals played a role.

1. **Describe** your specific experience or situation. In depicting your example, please ensure you portray the people involved (including yourself, if involved) and their respective roles, the situation, and any additional information that would be helpful for the reader to understand your example.

I once helped a manager from another team who asked me to complete a task that wasn't part of my role. Although I wasn't obligated to do it, I agreed because I didn't want to damage the relationship or be spoken badly of. Looking back, I realize that letting my private concerns about reputation influence that decision was unwise. It diverted time from my actual responsibilities and set a precedent that blurred professional boundaries. This taught me the importance of communicating respectfully and prioritizing my core duties.

2. **Examine** your example by connecting it to your learning from the course content. What specific concept(s) from Unit 01 or Unit 02 are relevant to your example? How did/does this example reinforce (or challenge) your own morality or the morality of the person you described in your example? Reference specific course material where applicable.

In this situation, my decision to help a manager outside my team was driven by a personal desire to avoid conflict rather than professional obligation. This reflects the concept of private vs. public morality from Unit 02, where personal values can conflict with role-based responsibilities. It also ties into the idea of a right vs. right dilemma, where both options—helping or declining—are ethically defensible but lead to different consequences. Choosing to help maintained interpersonal harmony but compromised my professional boundaries and risked setting unrealistic expectations for future interactions. This experience challenged my tendency to prioritize approval over accountability and reinforced the importance of making decisions based on role expectations, clear communication, and long-term professional integrity rather than short-term personal fears.

3. **Articulate your learning** by sharing what you do if you were presented with such a situation in the future? What factors might you consider to help influence your ethical decision making? What additional information might you need to make an informed decision?

If I were faced with a similar situation in the future, I would start by informing my direct manager before making any decisions. I would explain the request from the other team's manager and ask whether helping would be appropriate based on my current workload and responsibilities. This ensures transparency and allows me to make a more informed and balanced decision with my manager's input. When approaching ethical decisions like this, I would consider whether the request aligns with my role, whether I have the capacity to assist without neglecting my primary duties, and whether helping sets a precedent that could blur team boundaries or create future misunderstandings. I would also reflect on my motivation: am I agreeing to help because it's right, or simply to avoid conflict, gain approval, or protect my reputation?

To make a well-informed decision, I might need additional context—such as why I was asked specifically, whether the task is urgent, how it impacts overall team priorities, and if the request was made to others. Understanding these factors would help clarify whether the task is appropriate for me or better suited to someone else, and ensure my decision reflects both professionalism and ethical awareness.